FAMILY DEVOTIONS FOR THE WEEK

Faith Formation for Families • The Congregation at Prayer • Week of September 27 – October 3, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Invocation
In the name of the Father and of the ✠ Son and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

Introit (see back page)

Memory Verse for the Week — Psalm 91:11–12
"For He will command His angels concerning you to guard you in all your ways. On their hands they will bear you up, lest you strike your foot against a stone."

Daily Readings: LSB p. 299

Sun: Malachi 3:6—4:6; Matthew 4:12–25
Mon: Deuteronomy 1:1–18; Matthew 5:1–20
Tue: Deuteronomy 1:19–36; Matthew 5:21–48
Wed: Deuteronomy 1:37—2:15; Matthew 6:1–15
Thu: Deuteronomy 2:16–37; Matthew 6:16–34
Fri: Deuteronomy 3:1–29; Matthew 7:1–12
Sat: Deuteronomy 4:1–20; Matthew 7:13–29

Talk About It This Week
Each day, read the appointed readings (or just one), then ask: *Where did we hear God's Word planted today? What is God teaching us to trust?* Day-by-day questions for younger and older children are in the daily devotion pages (and on the web page).

In Our Prayers This Week (LSB Daily Prayer Themes)
✠ **Sun:** the joy of the resurrection; fruit of faith in all who heard the Word today
✠ **Mon:** our Baptism, callings, and daily work; schools; good government and peace
✠ **Tues:** deliverance from temptation and evil; the addicted and despairing
✠ **Wed:** marriage and family; parents and children; our home and community
✠ **Thurs:** the Church, pastors, teachers, and missionaries; thanksgiving for the Sacrament
✠ **Fri:** the preaching of the cross; the persecuted; the sick and the dying
✠ **Sat:** faithfulness to the end; hearts made ready for the Lord's Day

Hymn of the Week: "At the Name of Jesus" — LSB 512
At the name of Jesus / Ev'ry knee shall bow, / Ev'ry tongue confess Him / King of glory now. / 'Tis the Father's pleasure / We should call Him Lord, / Who from the beginning / Was the mighty Word.

Apostles' Creed

Lord's Prayer

Benediction
Let us bless the Lord. **Thanks be to God.**

HOW TO USE THIS PAGE… Gather once a day — at breakfast, supper, or bedtime. Speak the Invocation, say the memory verse together, read the day's readings, talk about them, sing the hymn stanza, pray for the day's theme, and close with the Lord's Prayer and Benediction. Ten minutes is plenty. The seed does the work — "so shall My word be… it shall not return to Me empty" (Isaiah 55:11).

The Eighteenth Sunday after Pentecost (Proper 21) September 27, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Introit *Psalm 147:1–5; antiphon: v. 6*

The LORD lifts up the humble;
he casts the wicked to the ground.
Praise the LORD! For it is good to sing praises to our God;
for it is pleasant, and a song of praise is fitting.
The LORD builds up Jerusalem;
he gathers the outcasts of Israel.
He heals the brokenhearted
and binds up their wounds.
He determines the number of the stars;
he gives to all of them their names.
Great is our Lord, and abundant in power;
his understanding is beyond measure.
Glory be to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit;
as it was in the beginning, is now, and will be forever. Amen.
The LORD lifts up the humble;
he casts the wicked to the ground.

Collect of the Day

Almighty God, You exalted Your Son to the place of all honor and authority. Enlighten our minds by Your Holy Spirit that, confessing Jesus as Lord, we may be led into all truth; through the same Jesus Christ, our Lord, who lives and reigns with You and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever. Amen.

This Sunday's Readings

Ezekiel 18:1–4, 25–32 · Psalm 25:1–10 · Philippians 2:1–4 (5–13) 14–18 · Matthew 21:23–27 (28–32)

Gradual *Psalm 91:11; 103:1*

For he will command his angels concerning you
to guard you in all your ways.
Bless the LORD, O my soul,
and all that is within me, bless his holy name!

Next Sunday's Readings (Proper 22)

Isaiah 5:1–7 · Psalm 80:7–19 · Philippians 3:4b–14 · Matthew 21:33–46

Learn by Heart: The Fourth Commandment *LSB p. 321*

"Honor your father and your mother. What does this mean? We should fear and love God so that we do not despise or anger our parents and other authorities, but honor them, serve and obey them, love and cherish them."

THIS WEEK AT HOME: The chief priests demand to know who gave Jesus the right to do what He does. He answers with a question they will not touch, and then a story: one son says no and goes anyway; the other says "I go, sir," and never moves. Which one did the father's will? This week Deuteronomy opens with Israel standing at the edge of the Promised Land — refusing to go in — while Matthew gives us the Sermon on the Mount. Ask one another: "Where have we said yes to God with our mouths this week and no with our feet?"

Kids in the Divine Service — What is the "pulpit"?

The pulpit is the raised place where the pastor preaches. The word comes from the Latin pulpitum, meaning "scaffold" — a platform lifted up high. Before microphones, raising the preacher helped everyone hear.

Lifting the pulpit above everything else also shows the importance of proclaiming God's pure Word. In this Sunday's Gospel the leaders ask Jesus, "By what authority are You doing these things?" The pulpit answers that question every week: the pastor does not speak on his own authority, but delivers Christ's Word.

Parents: *Before or after the service, let your children walk up to the pulpit and look out at the congregation, reminding them to be reverent in God's holy places. Before the sermon, remind them that pastor is about to preach God's Word.*

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